WEEKLY TRADING PERFORMANCE REPORT

Analysis Period: August 10-14, 2026
Report Generated: August 14, 2026
Trader: James
Accounts: LIVE options (Schwab). No shadow trades. No futures trades.
Strategies: SPX Bull Put Spreads (0DTE) — all six trades
Market: Second consecutive record week. Tame July CPI (+0.1% MoM, 3.4% YoY; core 2.5%) and softer PPI. SPX cleared 7,800 for
Themes: (1) Double-fill exposure event. (2) Premium compression at the floor. (3) Ten consecutive bull put spreads.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Overall Performance: +$1,200 gross across 6 trades (5 wins, 1 loss), +$1,060.32 net of $139.68 in fees and commissions. Excluding the single error trade, the week was 5 for 5 for +$1,300. Live options cumulative now **+$3,950 across 71 trades** — the best week of the live account and the second consecutive record week in the market.

The P&L; is the least interesting part of this week. Two things happened that matter more: two entry orders filled simultaneously and put roughly 37% of net liquidation value at risk by accident, and the credit floor became the binding constraint as volatility compressed. Neither cost much. Both are the kind of thing that costs a great deal in a worse week.

Key Findings:

- ★ DOUBLE-FILL (221/222): stacked contingent entries were not OCO-linked, so both filled. ~$19,325 combined max risk — about 37% of net liq — held for ~20 minutes. Materially the same exposure as trade 185, which was tagged ERROR. Fix self-diagnosed correctly.
- SETUP ERROR (223): position closed by mistake while building the bracket, 3 minutes after entry, -$100. A one-off execution slip, not a platform fault and not a pattern. Re-entered a minute later at a better credit.
- ★ PREMIUM COMPRESSION: trade 225 entered at exactly $0.60 — the Rule 21 floor — and James noted it as “a little below ideal but the best available at a comfortable delta.” Low VIX is squeezing the strategy against its own floor.
- Error pair 223→224 netted +$350, marginally better than holding the original would have paid (+$325). James flagged the outcome-bias trap himself in the journal before anyone else could.
- Ten consecutive bull put spreads (trades 217-226). Last bear call spread was trade 214 on 27 July. The book is implicitly long the market every single session.
- Three more first-hour entries (223, 224, 225), taking the running tally to six. All six have occurred in a relentlessly bullish, low-VIX regime.

P&L; SUMMARY

Book	Trades	Wins	Losses	Win %	P&L
Clean trades	5	5	0	100%	+$1,300
Error trade (223)	1	0	1	—	-$100
Gross total	6	5	1	83.3%	+$1,200
Less: fees & commissions	—	—	—	—	-$139.68
NET TOTAL	**6**	**5**	**1**	**83.3%**	**+$1,060.32**

CUMULATIVE TRACKING

Period	Trades	Win %	P&L (gross)	Cumulative
Study Period (Jun 29-Aug 4)	14	85.7%	+$2,370	+$1,675
Aug 5-7	4	100%	+$1,075	+$2,750
Aug 10-14 (this week)	6	83.3%	+$1,200	+$3,950

71 live options trades since inception. Cumulative figures gross of fees, consistent with prior reports. Futures book unchanged at -$215 across 15 trades — no futures activity this week.

TRADES

#	Date	Strikes	Cts	Entry	Exit	P&L	Cap.	Notes
221	10/08	7720/7700	5	$0.70	$0.30	+$200	57%	Gamma-scalp staged entry. 57 min.
222	10/08	7715/7695	5	$0.65	$0.40	+$125	39%	Simultaneous fill with 221. 16 min.
223	12/08	7695/7675	5	$0.75	$0.95	-$100	—	ERROR: closed while building OCO.
224	12/08	7695/7675	5	$1.00	$0.10	+$450	90%	Re-entry 1 min later at better credit.
225	13/08	7750/7730	5	$0.60	$0.10	+$250	83%	At the credit floor. ATH tape.
226	14/08	7750/7730	5	$0.65	$0.10	+$275	85%	Textbook. 11:40 ET, clean of first hour.

Amber: the double-fill pair. Red: the error trade. All six P&L; figures verified against (entry – exit) × contracts × 100.

THE DOUBLE-FILL: THE WEEK'S REAL EVENT

On Monday, James staged several contingent entry orders designed to trigger on upward price moves — a gamma-scalping approach into an advancing tape. The orders were **alternatives**: the intent was that one would fill. Because they were not OCO-linked, two filled almost simultaneously.

Metric	Value
Positions open simultaneously	221 (7720/7700) and 222 (7715/7695)
Combined spread width	$20,000
Combined max risk	$19,325
As % of net liquidation	~37% (per journal)
Duration of double exposure	~20 minutes
Working ceiling (Rule 6 framing)	20% of net liq for a high-conviction position
Comparable event	Trade 185 — 38% of net liq, tagged ERROR
Outcome	Both won. Combined +$325 gross.

Why this matters more than the $325 it made:

The strikes were adjacent — 7720/7700 and 7715/7695 — which means these were not two independent positions but effectively one 25-point-wide exposure at double size. A move through 7720 would have pressured both simultaneously. Correlation between them was close to total. The framework has a rule for exactly this (Rule 14: maximum two correlated positions with the same expiry) and this sat right at that limit while also nearly doubling the intended position size.

It is logged in the journal as "NONE — process gap." That is a defensible reading, since the intent was sound and only the order plumbing failed. But the risk taken was materially identical to trade 185, which carried 38% of net liq and was tagged ERROR. **The framework's own principle — a win on a rule break is still a rule break — argues for consistent tagging based on exposure taken, not on intent or outcome.** Consider re-tagging 222 as ERROR so the segmentation stays honest when this data is analysed later. This is a labelling point, not a criticism of the trade.

The fix, already correctly identified: James wrote it in the journal himself — "link staged alternative entries as first-triggers-cancels-the-rest so only one can open." That is exactly right, and it is a natural extension of Rule 16 (verify OCO cancellation). Proposed as a candidate rule:

R25 (candidate) — Staged alternative entries must be mutually exclusive. Where multiple contingent entry orders represent alternatives rather than a deliberate multi-position plan, they must be linked so the first fill cancels the remainder. Unlinked stacked entries are treated as a sizing breach regardless of outcome. *Source: trades 221/222, ~37% net liq for 20 minutes.*

TRADE 223: A SETUP ERROR, AND THE RECOVERY

Trade 223 was entered post-CPI with the catalyst resolved, VIX dropping sharply and ES rising — structurally the correct read, and the market went on to close at a record. Three minutes later the position was closed by mistake while the OCO [one-cancels-other] bracket was being set up. -$100.

This was a setup slip, not a platform defect — a distinction worth keeping clean in the journal, because human execution slips and tooling faults call for different fixes. One misclick across 71 live trades is not a pattern and does not indicate a rule change. It is logged, it cost $100, and the analysis behind the trade was sound enough that the re-entry a minute later proved it.

	Trade 223	Trade 224
Entry time (ET)	09:30	09:34
Strikes	7695/7675	7695/7675 (identical)
Credit	$0.75	$1.00
Outcome	Closed in error after 3 min	OCO filled at $0.10 — 90% capture
P&L	-$100	+$450

The pair netted +$350, marginally better than holding the original would have paid (+$325). James flagged the outcome-bias trap on this himself in the journal before anyone else could: the error still cost focus and could as easily have cost money. The genuinely useful observation is the reflex — re-entering one minute later at a better credit is the same behaviour as trades 217→218 last week. Recovering from a setback by waiting for a better price, rather than chasing the original, is now showing up consistently.

PREMIUM COMPRESSION AT THE FLOOR

Trade 225 was entered at exactly $0.60 — the Rule 21 minimum credit floor. James logged it honestly: “a little below ideal but the best available at a comfortable delta in a strongly bullish tape.” That sentence describes a structural squeeze worth naming.

As volatility compresses, the premium available at any given strike distance falls. To keep collecting $0.80+ you must either move the short strike closer (raising breach risk) or accept less credit (reducing stop headroom and worsening fee drag). The floor stops you doing the second thing indefinitely — which is its job — but it means **the calm, grinding-higher markets in which this strategy posts its best win rates are also the markets in which its unit economics are worst.**

Fee drag as a function of credit (5 lots, ~$23.13 round-trip costs):

Credit per share	Premium collected	Fees	Drag %
$0.60 (the floor)	$300	$23.13	7.7%
$0.65	$325	$23.13	7.1%
$0.75	$375	$23.13	6.2%
$0.80	$400	$23.13	5.8%
$1.00	$500	$23.13	4.6%
$1.20	$600	$23.13	3.9%

Trade 224 at $1.00 carried 4.6% drag. Trade 225 at $0.60 carried 7.7% — **two-thirds more cost for the same trade structure and the same $23.13 of fees.** This week's aggregate drag was 6.42% of premium collected, or 11.64% of gross P&L;: $139.68 against $1,200. Fees scale with contracts and are indifferent to credit, so the only lever that improves the ratio is credit per contract. Trading larger makes the absolute number worse and the ratio no better.

Two options worth weighing (not a recommendation to act this week):

- Hold the $0.60 floor and simply trade less often in compressed-vol regimes, accepting fewer opportunities rather than worse ones. This is the conservative reading and is consistent with the frequency reduction that worked so well during the study period.
- Raise the working floor toward $0.75-$0.80 for calm regimes specifically, which would have excluded trade 225 (a winner) but also improves the fee ratio and the stop headroom on every trade taken. This is the option the backtesting engine should evaluate rather than intuition.

DIRECTIONAL CONCENTRATION: TEN CONSECUTIVE BULL PUT SPREADS

Every trade in this report and the last is a bull put spread. Trades 217 through 226 — ten in a row. The most recent bear call spread was trade 214 on 27 July.

No rule prohibits this. Rule 14 governs correlated positions *within the same expiry*, and these are sequential 0DTE positions on different days. But at the book level, the account has been implicitly long the market every session for three weeks. In a tape making consecutive record highs that is the momentum-aligned trade and it has paid well. The exposure it creates is that a regime turn does not affect one position — it affects the approach.

This is worth holding alongside a fact from the study-period report: across that sample, **bear call spreads averaged +$317 per trade at a 100% win rate versus +$104 for bull put spreads.** The book has since drifted entirely to the lower-performing side — not through a decision, but because the tape has only offered one direction. That is a reasonable response to conditions. It is worth being conscious that it happened by drift rather than by choice, and worth noting that the June bearish stretch is the honest guide to how a ten-deep BPS habit behaves when the market turns.

FIRST-HOUR ENTRIES: TALLY NOW SIX

Trade	Date	Entry ET	Catalyst / Read	Result
217	05/08	09:50	None — no read documented	+$25 gross, +$1.42 net

Trade	Date	Entry ET	Catalyst / Read	Result
219	06/08	09:46	VIX falling, ES range-bound	+$350
220	07/08	09:31	Post-jobs print, binary resolved	+$350
223	12/08	09:30	Post-CPI, binary resolved	-$100 (order error, not timing)
224	12/08	09:34	Post-CPI re-entry	+$450
225	13/08	10:01	Bullish tape (PPI had landed 08:30)	+$250

The sample is building and the pattern from last week holds: the entries with a resolved catalyst or a documented read have performed; the single entry with neither (217) was punished immediately. Trade 223's loss was an order-handling error, not a timing failure — the read was correct and trade 224 proved it one minute later.

The caveat has not weakened, it has hardened. All six instances occurred in a market printing consecutive record highs with VIX low and falling, and all six were bull put spreads. That is a single regime and a single direction. Six wins under those conditions tells you very little about first-hour entries in a falling or choppy tape — which is precisely the condition G3 was written for.

Suggested re-review condition: revisit G3 once the log contains at least five first-hour entries taken in a non-bullish regime (VIX above 20, or a week where SPX closes lower). Until then, keep flagging them exactly as you have been. The flagging is what is keeping this honest.

MARKET CONTEXT

Monday 10 Aug: Momentum carried over from the previous week's 3.58% gain. SPX traded near 7,771, holding above the prior record close of 7,757.64. Advancing tape suited the gamma-scalping staged entries of trades 221 and 222.

Wednesday 12 Aug — CPI: July CPI rose 0.1% month-on-month for an annual rate of 3.4%, matching consensus. Core CPI increased 0.2% monthly with the annual rate at 2.5%. A muted print that took the September-hike scare off the boil. VIX dropped sharply on release and ES rose — the conditions James read correctly for trades 223 and 224.

Thursday 13 Aug — PPI and the record: Producer inflation came in softer than expected, adding to Wednesday's benign picture. SPX reached a fresh all-time intraday high, surpassing 7,800 for the first time ever and closing at a record 7,798.99 (+0.65%). Nasdaq +0.81% to 26,803.03. Brent and WTI both fell more than 2%. This is the session in which trade 225 was placed at the credit floor.

Friday 14 Aug: Stocks mixed following the record close, with the index up roughly 0.65% for the week. Trade 226 was the textbook entry of the week — 11:40 ET, clean of the first hour, 85% capture in about 2.4 hours.

Relevance: two consecutive record weeks with falling volatility is close to the ideal environment for selling put premium, and the results reflect that. Five clean wins from five in these conditions is the strategy doing what it should. It is not evidence about the strategy's behaviour anywhere else on the volatility spectrum.

FRAMEWORK COMPLIANCE

Rule	Status	Notes
R21: Min credit floor $0.60	PASS (tight)	All six at $0.60-$1.00. Trade 225 exactly at the floor.
R20: Close 0DTE by 3:30pm ET	PASS	All closed intraday via OCO or manual exit.
R19: No binary catalysts	PASS ✔	Trades 223/224 entered AFTER the 08:30 CPI print resolved. Correct application.
Execution accuracy	ONE SLIP	Trade 223 — setup error during bracket construction. Isolated, correctly logged, -$100.
R14: Max 2 correlated same expiry	AT LIMIT	221/222 adjacent strikes, same expiry. At the ceiling by accident, not design.
R6: 20% BP reserve	BREACHED	221+222 combined ~37% net liq for ~20 min. Logged as ‘process gap’; exposure equivalent to trade 185 (tagged ERROR).
G3: No first-hour entries	BREACHED ×3	223, 224, 225. All self-flagged. Running tally now six.
R9: Commissions under 2%	BREACHED	6.42%. Structural at this premium level — rule scope still needs revising, as flagged last week.
Mistakes column	LOGGED WELL	Every breach self-flagged with reasoning. Double-fill fix self-diagnosed correctly.

Three breaches, none of which cost money, all of which could have. That sentence is the summary of the week. The R6 breach is the one to sit with: 37% of net liquidation value was at risk for twenty minutes because two orders that were meant to be alternatives were not linked. It resolved profitably. The next time that happens the market may be moving the other way.

LESSONS LEARNED

WHAT WORKED

- ✓ Five clean trades, five wins, +$1,300. Best week of the live account.
- ✓ Trade 226 is the model: entered 11:40 ET clean of the first hour, $0.65 credit, OCO closed at $0.10 for 85% capture. No breaches, no drama.
- ✓ Post-CPI reads on trades 223/224 were correct — VIX dropping, ES rising, catalyst resolved. The loss came from a setup slip, not from the analysis.

- ✓ The re-entry instinct: 224 opened one minute after the error close at $1.00, better than the original $0.75. Same pattern as 217→218 last week. Patience after a setback is becoming reflexive.
- ✓ Self-diagnosis quality: the double-fill fix (‘first-triggers-cancels-the-rest’) was identified in the journal without prompting, and the outcome-bias caution on the error pair was flagged before anyone else could raise it.
- ✓ Mechanised exits again did the work — 224, 225 and 226 all closed on OCO limits with no discretionary decision at the back end.

WHAT NEEDS ATTENTION

- **1. Link staged entries before trading them again.** R25 candidate. Until the orders are mutually exclusive, staged gamma-scalp entries carry an uncontrolled sizing risk. This is the highest-priority item this week.
- **2. Consider re-tagging trade 222 as ERROR.** The exposure was equivalent to trade 185. Consistent tagging keeps the clean/error segmentation trustworthy when this data is analysed at scale.
- **3. The credit floor is now binding.** Decide deliberately whether to hold $0.60 and trade less in calm regimes, or lift the working floor for compressed-vol conditions. Worth putting to the backtesting engine rather than resolving by feel.
- **4. Rules 9 and 18 remain unresolved from last week.** Both still conflict with the core strategy as literally written. They should be re-scoped in the framework document so the exceptions are explicit rather than habitual.

CONCLUSION

+$1,200 gross, +$1,060 net, five clean wins from five. Live options cumulative +$3,950 across 71 trades. The best week the live account has had, in the second consecutive record week for the market. Those two facts belong in the same sentence, as they did last week.

The week's real content is in the near-miss. Two orders filled that should have been one, putting 37% of net liquidation value at risk for twenty minutes. Alongside it, the credit floor became a binding constraint rather than a comfortable backstop. Neither cost anything meaningful. Both are the sort of thing that, in a week where the tape is falling instead of climbing, becomes the headline instead of a footnote.

The pattern across three weeks is worth naming plainly. The strategy is performing beautifully in a regime that suits it perfectly — rising, low-volatility, record-setting. Ten consecutive bull put spreads, a fifteen-trade stretch with one small loss, and mechanised OCO exits doing the hard part. That is a system working. It is also, at this point, an untested system in the only conditions that genuinely test it. The June bearish stretch, where the stops earned $12,390 in a single week, remains the honest reference point for what happens when the tape turns.

And the thing that continues to make this work. Three framework breaches and one execution slip, and you flagged every one yourself before this report existed — including diagnosing the fix for the double-fill and raising the outcome-bias trap on your own error pair. That is the discipline that separates a trading record from a trading journal. Keep doing exactly that.

Next Report: Friday, August 21, 2026
